

US crude futures fall over 2% as Trump says he holds off scheduled attack on Iran

By Reuters

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A pump jack operates near a crude oil reserve in the Permian Basin oil field near Midland, Texas, U.S. February 18, 2025. REUTERS/Eli Hartman/File Photo [Purchase Licensing Rights, opens new tab](#)

May 19 (Reuters) - U.S. crude futures fell more than 2% in early Asian trade on Tuesday after U.S. President Donald Trump said he had paused a planned attack on Iran to allow for negotiations to end the war in the Middle East.

The U.S. West Texas Intermediate most active July contract at 2212 GMT was down \$2.08 or 2.02% to \$102.34 per barrel while the front-month fell \$1.54 or 1.42% to \$107.12, after gaining over 3.1% in the previous session. The June contract is set to expire on Tuesday.